

REST Method-Map Card

Day 3 handout. The five HTTP methods, what each is for, and whether it's idempotent. Plus the status codes that carry meaning. Keep it beside you while you sketch resource models.

REST treats the system as a set of **resources** (nouns) accessed by standard HTTP methods (verbs).

METHOD	PURPOSE	IDEMPOTENT?
GET	Retrieve	Yes
POST	Create	No
PUT	Replace	Yes
PATCH	Update partially	No (typically)
DELETE	Remove	Yes

URLs reflect resources

`/dispatchers/{id}/reconciles/{id}` — nouns, nested for sub-resources. Use `/<plural>/{id}` for an individual resource.

Status codes carry meaning

200 · 201 · 204 · 400 · 401 · 403 · 404 · 409 · 422 · 429 · 500 · 502 · 503

Specific codes carry actionable distinctions — 422 vs 400 vs 409 are not interchangeable. Don't lump everything at 400/500.

Two rookie errors to avoid

- **Verbs in URLs.** `POST /lists/{id}/shares` (resource) beats `POST /lists/{id}/share` (verb). REST nudges toward nouns even when an action is involved.
- **Path vs query confusion.** Ask "am I *identifying* a resource or *filtering* a set?" Identifying → path parameter. Filtering → query parameter.